Decisions and Candidate Care Playbook

Make the offer well, and close the loop with everyone else, including candidates you do not select.

How to use it. Keep this open from the final interview until the last candidate has heard back. Adapt the messages to your own voice.

1. After the decision

- [ ] Decision and reason recorded the same day
- [ ] Selected candidate called by the hiring manager, not just emailed
- [ ] Written offer sent with the details agreed on the call
- [ ] Every other candidate told within the time we promised
- [ ] Interviewers thanked and told the outcome
- [ ] Anything we learned about the process is written down

2. The offer conversation

What I want them to hear	What they will want to know
Why we chose them, in specifics	Role, team, start, compensation, next steps

MESSAGE TO A SELECTED CANDIDATE

Hi [name], thank you for the time and thought you put into every stage. The team has talked it through and we would like to offer you the role of [title]. What stood out for us was [two specifics]. I will call you on [day] to walk through the details, and you will get the written offer straight after. Meanwhile, ask me anything.

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3. Candidates we do not select

This is the part most teams skip, and the part candidates remember. A prompt, kind and specific reply costs a few minutes and protects your reputation for years.

AFTER AN EARLY STAGE

Hi [name], thank you for applying for [title] and for sharing your work. We have decided not to move forward this time. [One specific thing you noticed, if you can share it.] We would be glad to hear from you again for future roles, and if you have any feedback about how we ran the process, I would value it.

AFTER THE FINAL STAGE

Hi [name], thank you for the time you gave us across [stages]. It was a difficult decision, and we have gone with a candidate whose experience matched [specific area] more closely. What impressed us was [specific strength]. I would be glad to give you more detailed feedback on a call if useful, and we would like to stay in touch.

4. What we will share, and when

STAGE THE CANDIDATE REACHED	REPLY WITHIN	WHAT WE SHARE	WHO SENDS IT
After application			
After screening			
After portfolio conversation			
After the craft exercise			
After final conversations			

5. Keeping the door open

How we will keep strong candidates in touch, with their permission

6. Ask every candidate

- [ ] Did you always know what would happen next?
- [ ] Was the time asked of you fair?
- [ ] Did interviewers seem prepared and respectful?
- [ ] What would you change about how we hire?

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